

Introduction to Computer Programming

Fundamentals of C

Amit Kumar Singh
Assistant Professor (ECE)
School of Naval Architecture and Ocean Engineering
Indian Maritime University Visakhapatnam Campus, Sabbavaram Mandal
Visakhapatnam, Andhra Pradesh – 531 035
amitkumarsingh@imu.ac.in

August 18, 2026

Outline

- 1 Introduction to Computer Organization
- 2 Evolution of Operating Systems
- 3 Machine, Assembly & High-Level Languages
- 4 Software & Hardware Trends; Programming Methodologies
- 5 Program Development in C
- 6 Structured Programming: Algorithms & Pseudo-code
- 7 Anatomy of a C Program
- 8 The C Standard Library
- 9 Data Types in C
- 10 Operators in C
- 11 Input and Output in C
- 12 Control Structures
- 13 Writing First C Programs

What is a Computer?

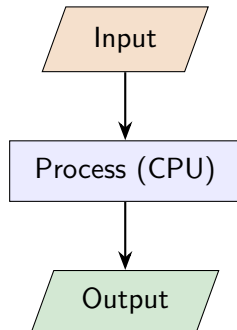
Definition

A **computer** is an electronic machine that accepts **data** (input), processes it according to a set of **instructions** (a program), and produces useful **information** (output).

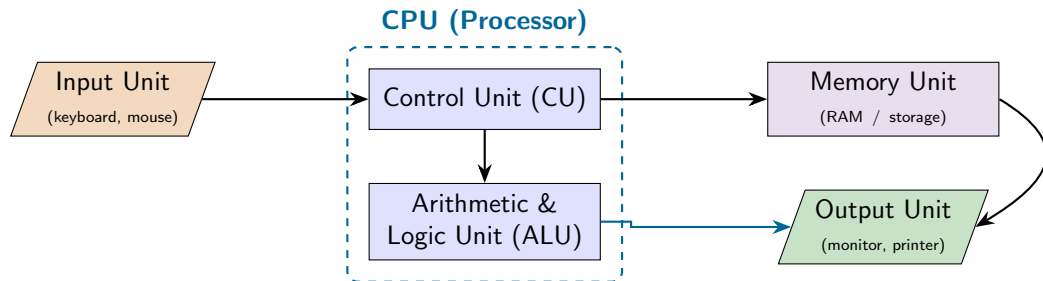
- It follows the simple cycle:

INPUT → PROCESS → OUTPUT

- It cannot “think” — it only does exactly what the program tells it, very fast and without mistakes.
- Programming* is the art of writing those instructions.



Computer Organization: The Building Blocks



- **CPU** = “brain”. **CU** directs traffic; **ALU** does the maths & comparisons.
- **Memory** temporarily holds data & instructions the CPU is working on.

Hardware vs. Software & Types of Memory

Hardware

The physical parts you can *touch* — CPU, RAM, hard disk, keyboard, monitor.

Software

The *programs* (instructions) that tell the hardware what to do — e.g. Windows, a game, a C program.

Primary Memory (fast, temporary)

- **RAM** — working memory, lost when power is off (volatile).
- **ROM** — read-only, permanent start-up instructions.

Secondary Memory (slow, permanent)

- Hard disk, SSD, USB drive — stores files even without power.

Real-World Application of Different Types of Memory

RAM

While the device is running

- Open a C program in an IDE.
- The program is loaded from storage into RAM.
- CPU accesses instructions and data from RAM.
- Closing the program releases the RAM.
- Power OFF → contents are lost.

ROM

When the device starts

- Contains firmware / boot instructions.
- CPU executes these instructions after power ON.
- Performs initial hardware setup.
- Helps start the operating system.
- Contents remain after power OFF.

Secondary Storage

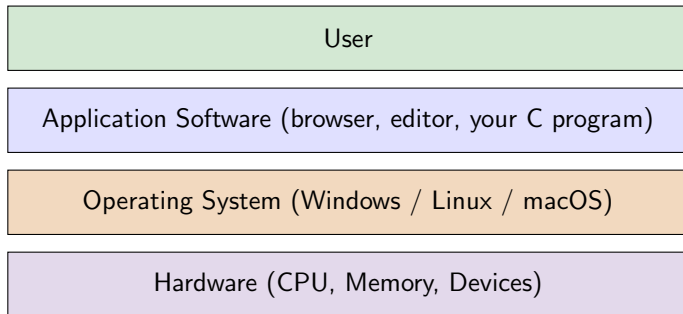
Long-term storage

- Stores the operating system.
- Stores C source files and executables.
- Stores documents, photos and videos.
- Data remains after power OFF.
- Examples: SSD, HDD, USB drive.

What is an Operating System (OS)?

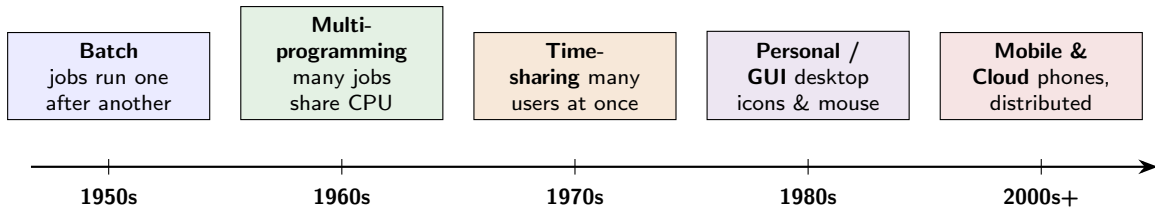
Operating System

An OS is the **master software** that manages the hardware and gives other programs a place to run. It is the bridge between **you**, the **programs**, and the **hardware**.



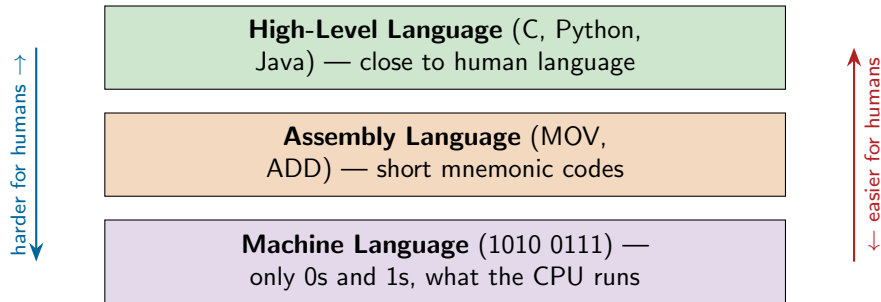
Examples of tasks: managing memory, running programs, handling files, controlling devices.

Evolution of Operating Systems: A Timeline



- Each stage made the computer **easier to use** and able to do **more at once**.
- Modern OSES let many programs and users run *simultaneously* on the same machine.

Levels of Programming Languages



- The CPU understands **only** machine language (binary).
- We write in a high-level language; a **translator** converts it to machine code.

Comparing the Three Levels

Feature	Human friendliness	Example (add 2 numbers)
Machine	Very hard (all 0/1)	10110000 01100001
Assembly	Hard (mnemonics)	MOV AL, 61 ^H AL ← 61 ^H ADD AL, BL AL ← AL+BL
High-level	Easy (English-like)	c = a + b;

Key idea

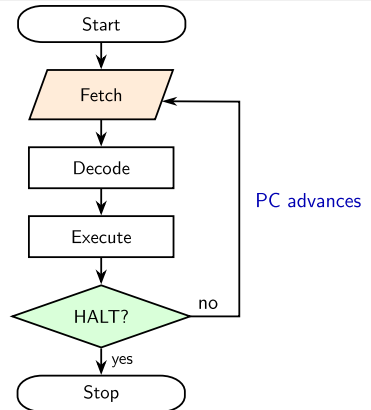
High-level languages like **C** let us write *one* readable line instead of many cryptic machine instructions — and the same C program can run on many different machines.

How the CPU Runs a Program: The Machine Cycle

The Fetch—Decode—Execute cycle

To run a program, the CPU repeats one basic cycle — called the **machine cycle** (or **instruction cycle**) — once for *every* instruction, billions of times per second.

- 1 **Fetch** — the Control Unit copies the next instruction from **memory**. The *Program Counter* (PC) holds its address; the instruction is placed in the *Instruction Register* (IR).
- 2 **Decode** — the Control Unit works out *what* the instruction means and which parts of the CPU are needed.
- 3 **Execute** — the instruction is carried out: the **ALU** does the arithmetic/logic, or data is moved. The PC then advances, and the cycle repeats for the next instruction.



The Machine Cycle: A Worked Example

Running $c = a + b$ on the CPU

A single C line becomes a few machine instructions. The CPU runs each one through its own **Fetch–Decode–Execute** cycle.

#	Instruction	Fetch & Decode	Execute
1	LOAD a	get “LOAD a”, CU sees a load	copy a from memory into a register
2	ADD b	get “ADD b”, CU sees an add	ALU adds b to that register
3	STORE c	get “STORE c”, CU sees a store	write the result into c in memory
4	HALT	get “HALT”	stop the cycle

- After each instruction the **Program Counter** moves on, so the CPU automatically fetches the next one.
- The whole program is just this tiny cycle, repeated very fast.

Key Software & Hardware Trends

Hardware trends

- **Moore's Law:** transistor count roughly doubles $\sim$ every 2 years $\rightarrow$ faster, cheaper chips.
- Multi-core CPUs, GPUs.
- Smaller & mobile: phones, embedded, IoT.
- Cloud data-centres provide computing “on tap”.

Software trends

- Open-source software & reusable libraries.
- Mobile apps and web applications.
- Artificial Intelligence & data science.
- Higher-level, safer languages built *on top of C*.

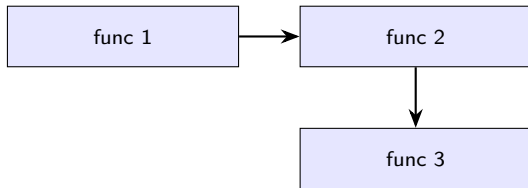
Hardware gets faster and cheaper; software gets smarter and more connected — and **C** sits underneath much of it.

Procedural vs. Object-Oriented Programming

Procedural (e.g. C)

Program = a sequence of **procedures** / **functions** that operate on data.

- Think: a *recipe* — do step 1, then 2, then 3.
- Data and functions are separate.



Object-Oriented (e.g. C++, Python, Java)

Program = a set of **objects** that bundle data *and* the functions acting on it.

- Think: real-world *objects* (a Car that can `start()`, `stop()`).
- Ideas: class, object, inheritance.

```
CLASS Car
  DATA: speed
  METHODS:
    start()
    accelerate()
    stop()
END CLASS
```

In this course we focus on the **procedural** style using **C**.

Why C?

- Created by **Dennis Ritchie** at Bell Labs (early 1970s).
- **Powerful** yet **small** — close to the hardware but readable.
- The “mother language”: Linux, databases, and parts of Windows are written in C.
- Learning C teaches you how a computer *really* works.

C is a great first language because

- It is **fast**.
- It is used **everywhere**.
- Its ideas carry over to C++, Java, Python, ...

Common C-related File Extensions

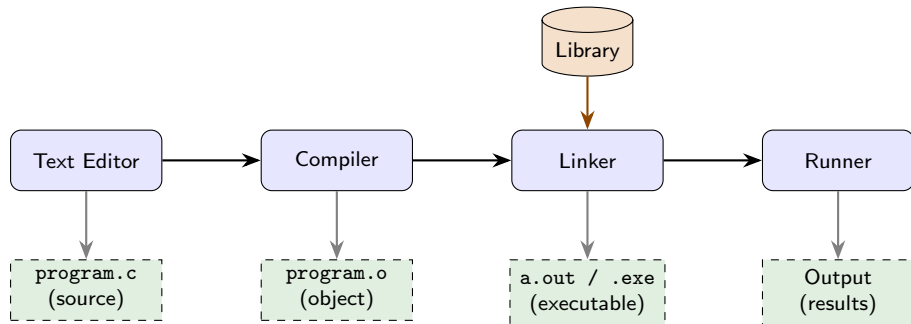
Extension	Meaning
.c	C source code
.h	C header file
.o	Object file (Linux/macOS)
.obj	Object file (Windows/MSVC ¹)
.exe	Executable file (Windows)

Key Point

C program/source file → .c extension

¹MSVC stands for Microsoft Visual C++

From Source Code to Running Program



One command does it all (using GCC)

```
>> gcc program.c -o program
>> ./program
```

Each step's output feeds the next. If the compiler reports **errors**, fix them and compile again — this “edit → compile → run” loop is normal!

- **Text Editor:** Place where we write the program.

- **Compiler:** Translates C source code into object code that the computer can understand.

hello.c → Compiler → hello.o

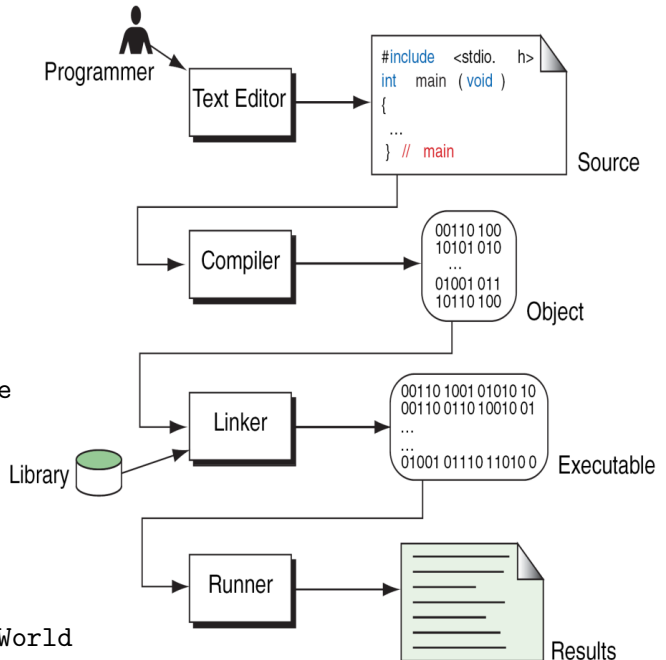
- **Linker:** Combines object files and required libraries to create the executable.

hello.o → Linker → hello.exe

↑
C Standard Library

- **Runner:** The runner is the part that starts/executes the compiled executable program.

hello.exe → Runner → Hello World



Translators: Compiler vs. Interpreter

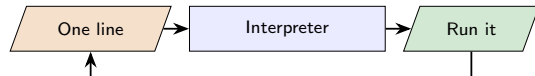
Why we need a translator

A **translator** converts our high-level C into machine code. The two main kinds are the **compiler** and the **interpreter**.

Compiler (C uses this)

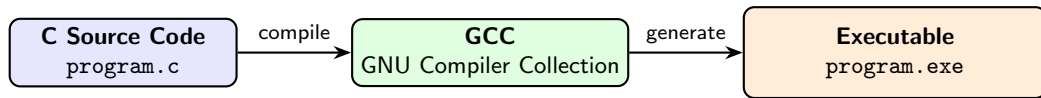


Interpreter (e.g. Python)



Compiler	Interpreter
Translates the <i>whole</i> program at once	Translates <i>line by line</i>
Produces a separate executable file	No separate executable file
Faster; all errors reported together	Slower; errors reported line-wise

Compiler² Used in This Course



Course Standard

All C programs in this course are compiled using **GCC (GNU Compiler Collection)**.

One command does it all (using GCC)

```
>> gcc program.c -o program
```

→ Compile and create the executable program

```
>> ./program
```

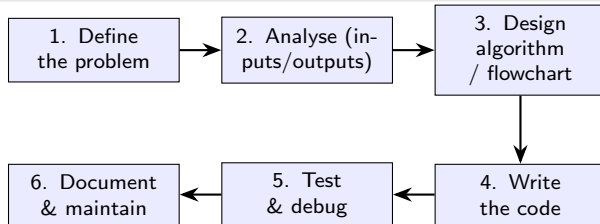
→ Run the compiled program

²The C compiler is invoked using the `gcc` command.

Steps in Problem Solving

Before writing code, plan the solution

Good programmers think first, then type. Solving a problem on a computer follows a clear set of steps.



- **Analysis** asks: what are the *inputs*, the *outputs*, and the *constraints*?
- Only step 4 is actual coding — most of the thinking happens *before* it.

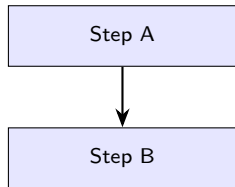
Structured Programming

Idea

Build every program from just **three** basic control structures. This keeps code clear, correct, and easy to read (no “spaghetti” jumps).

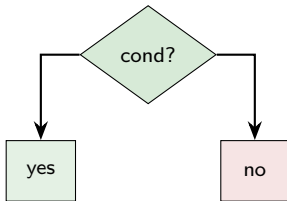
1. Sequence

(do in order)



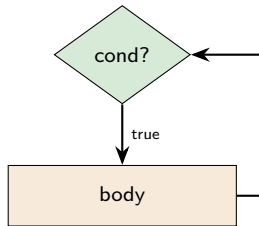
2. Selection

(choose a path)



3. Repetition

(loop)



Algorithm and Pseudo-code

Algorithm

A finite, step-by-step procedure to solve a problem — *before* writing any code.

Pseudo-code

An informal, English-like sketch of the code — language independent.

Algorithm: add two numbers

- 1 Start
- 2 Read two numbers a and b
- 3 Compute $\text{sum} = a + b$
- 4 Display sum
- 5 Stop

BEGIN

INPUT a, b

$\text{sum} \leftarrow a + b$

OUTPUT sum

END

Good pseudo-code translates almost line-by-line into C.

Characteristics of a Good Algorithm

- **Input** — zero or more well-defined inputs.
- **Output** — at least one useful output.
- **Definiteness** — every step is precise and unambiguous.
- **Finiteness** — it must end after a finite number of steps.
- **Effectiveness** — each step is basic enough to be carried out.

Rule of thumb

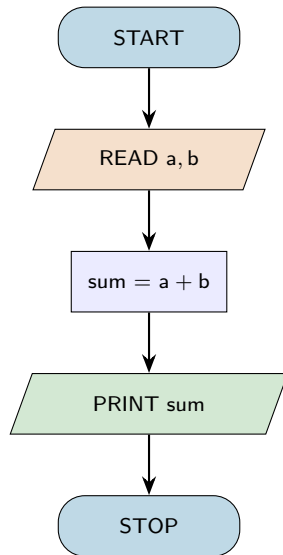
If a stranger can follow your steps and get the *same* correct answer every time, it is a good algorithm.

Why it matters

A clear algorithm makes the C code almost write itself — and makes bugs easy to spot.

Flowcharts

- A flowchart is a graphical representation of an algorithm, using standard symbols to illustrate the sequence of operations and flow of control.
- Programmers often use it as a program-planning tool to solve a problem.
- It makes use of symbols that are connected among them to indicate the flow of information and processing.
- The process of drawing a flowchart for an algorithm is known as “flowcharting”.
- **Algorithm: add two numbers**
 - 1 Start
 - 2 Read two numbers ‘a’ and ‘b’
 - 3 Compute $\text{sum} = a + b$
 - 4 Display sum
 - 5 Stop



Flowchart Symbols You Should Know



Start or end of the program



Computational steps or processing function of a program



Input or output operation



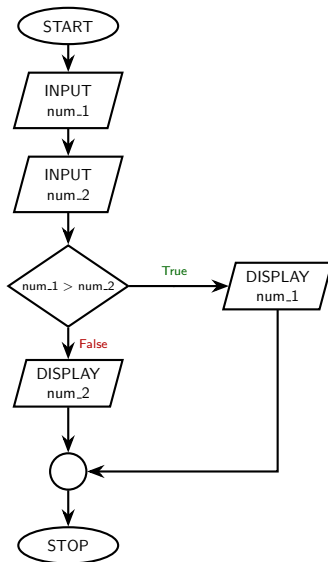
Decision making and branching



Connector or joining of two parts of program

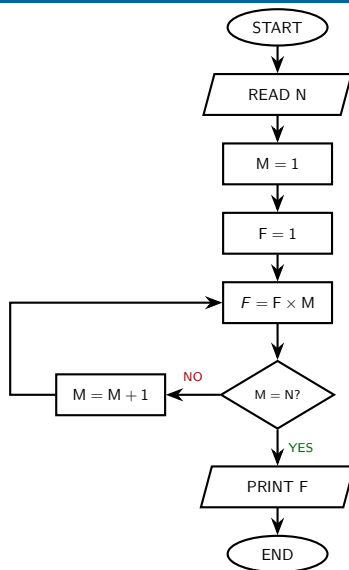
Flowcharts Examples

- ① START
- ② READ two numbers 'num_1' and 'num_2'
- ③ Compare num_1 and num_2
- ④ If $\text{num}_1 > \text{num}_2$
 DISPLAY num_1
- ⑤ Otherwise
 DISPLAY num_2
- ⑥ STOP



Flowchart Examples (cont...)

- 1 START
- 2 READ a number 'N'
- 3 Initialize $M = 1$
- 4 Initialize $F = 1$
- 5 Compute $F = F * M$
- 6 If $M = N$
 Print F and
 go to Step 8
- 7 Otherwise
 increment M by 1 and
 repeat Step 5
- 8 STOP



The Skeleton of Every C Program

```
#include <stdio.h>    /* 1: header */

int main(void)        /* 2: start  */
{                    /* 3: body   */
    /* your statements go here */

    return 0;        /* 4: exit   */
}
```

- ④ `return 0` — terminates `main()` and indicates successful completion to the host environment.

① Preprocessor directive

- `#include` — preprocessor directive in C. It tells the preprocessor to include the contents of a specified header file before the actual compilation begins.
- `stdio.h` — **s**tandard **i**nput/**o**utput header file
`scanf()`, `printf()`

- ② `int main(void)` — program's entry point; execution always begins here; every program has exactly one "`main()`".

- `int` — the function returns an integer value to the host environment.
- `void` — the function takes no arguments.

- ③ **Body** — The statements and declarations enclosed between `{ }`. Many C statements end with `;`, but not all C constructs do.

Note: Reaching the closing `}` of `main()` is equivalent to `return 0;`.

The C Character Set and Tokens

Character set

The symbols C understands:

- Letters A--Z, a--z
- Digits 0--9
- Special symbols + - * / = % ; ,
...
- Whitespace (space, tab, newline)

Tokens — the smallest units

Characters group into **tokens**:

Keywords

int

Identifiers

sum

Constants

42

Strings

"Hi"

Operators

+ =

Symbols

; { }

A compiler first breaks your code into these tokens.

Keywords: C's Reserved Words

What is a keyword?

- A **keyword** has a fixed, special meaning in C.
- There are **32** of them — you cannot use them as your own names.
- C is **case-sensitive**: `int` is a keyword, `INT` is not.

<code>auto</code>	<code>break</code>	<code>case</code>	<code>char</code>	<code>const</code>	<code>continue</code>	<code>default</code>	<code>do</code>
<code>double</code>	<code>else</code>	<code>enum</code>	<code>extern</code>	<code>float</code>	<code>for</code>	<code>goto</code>	<code>if</code>
<code>int</code>	<code>long</code>	<code>register</code>	<code>return</code>	<code>short</code>	<code>signed</code>	<code>sizeof</code>	<code>static</code>
<code>struct</code>	<code>switch</code>	<code>typedef</code>	<code>union</code>	<code>unsigned</code>	<code>void</code>	<code>volatile</code>	<code>while</code>

The ones we use most as beginners: `int`, `float`, `char`, `if`, `else`, `for`, `while`, `return`.

Identifiers: Naming the Variables

Identifier

The **name** given to a variable, function, or constant.

Rules

- Use letters, digits, and underscore _
- Must *start* with a letter or underscore _ (not a digit)
- No spaces and no special symbols
- Cannot be a keyword
- Case-sensitive: age $\neq$ Age

Valid	Invalid
total	2sum (starts with digit)
marks1	my age (has a space)
_count	float (keyword)
avgScore	rate% (bad symbol)

Tip: choose *meaningful* names like total, not t.

The C Standard Library

What is it?

A ready-made collection of **functions** that come with C, so you don't reinvent the wheel. You get access to them with `#include <header.h>`.

Header	Purpose	Example functions
<code>stdio.h</code>	input / output	<code>printf</code> , <code>scanf</code> , <code>getchar</code> , <code>fopen</code> , <code>fclose</code>
<code>stdlib.h</code>	general utilities	<code>malloc</code> , <code>rand</code> , <code>abs</code> , <code>atoi</code> ³
<code>math.h</code>	mathematics	<code>sqrt</code> ⁴ , <code>pow</code> , <code>sin</code> , <code>ceil</code>
<code>string.h</code>	text handling	<code>strlen</code> , <code>strcpy</code> , <code>strcmp</code>
<code>ctype.h</code>	character tests	<code>isdigit</code> , <code>toupper</code>

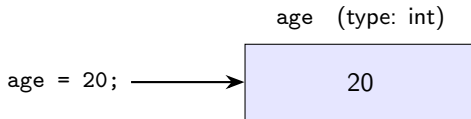
³ASCII stands for American Standard Code for Information Interchange. It is a 7-bit character encoding standard that assigns numbers from 0 to 127 to specific letters, numbers, punctuation marks, and control commands, allowing computers to translate and share text data universally.

⁴e.g. `#include <math.h>` then `y = sqrt(25.0);` gives `y = 5.0`

Variables and Data Types

Variable

- A **named box** in memory that stores a value.
- Must declare its *type* first.
- e.g. `int age = 20;`



- The **type** decides what values fit and how much memory is used.
- Choose the smallest type that comfortably accommodates the data.

The Basic Data Types

Type	Stores	Typical size	Example
int	whole numbers	4 bytes	<code>int n = 42;</code>
float	real numbers (decimals)	4 bytes	<code>float g = 9.8f;</code>
double	real numbers (more precise)	8 bytes	<code>double pi = 3.14159;</code>
char	a single character	1 byte	<code>char grade = 'A';</code>
NULL	null pointer value	—	<code>int *p = NULL;</code>

Modifiers

short, long, unsigned adjust range/size, e.g.
unsigned int (no negatives), long int (bigger).

A character is a small number

'A' is stored as the integer 65 (its ASCII code).

Size and Range of Each Variable

Every type occupies a fixed amount of memory

The **size** (in bytes) decides the **range** of values a variable can hold. Sizes are typical for a modern computer.

Type	Size	Bits	Approx. range	Specifier
char	1 byte	8	−128 to 127	%c
int	4 bytes	32	-2.1×10^9 to 2.1×10^9	%d
float	4 bytes	32	~6–7 significant digits	%f
double	8 bytes	64	~15 significant digits	%lf

Find the size yourself

The `sizeof()` operator returns a type's size in bytes:

```
printf("%d", sizeof(int));  
// prints 4
```

Constants: Values That Never Change

Constant

A value that is fixed and **cannot be changed** while the program runs (e.g. π , the number of days in a week). Using constants makes code safer and easier to read.

Using the `const` keyword:

```
const float PI = 3.14159;  
const int DAYS = 7;
```

Using `#define` (a macro):

```
#define MAX 100  
#define PI 3.14159
```

- `const` makes a *typed* read-only variable;
- `#define` does a plain text substitution before compiling.
- By convention, constants are written in UPPERCASE. Trying to change one is an error.

Variable Scope: Local vs. Global

```
int x = 5;           /* global */

int main(void) {
    int y = 10;      /* local  */
    printf("%d %d", x, y);
    return 0;
}
```

Scope = where a variable is visible

- **Local** — declared *inside* a function; usable only there.
- **Global** — declared *outside* all functions; usable everywhere.

Prefer local variables — they keep parts of the program independent and reduce accidental bugs.

Arithmetic Operators

Operator	Meaning	Example	Result
+	addition	$7 + 3$	10
-	subtraction	$7 - 3$	4
*	multiplication	$7 * 3$	21
/	division	$7 / 3$	2 (integer!)
%	modulus ⁵ (remainder)	$7 \% 3$	1

Beginner trap: integer division

$7 / 3$ gives 2, *not* 2.33, because both are integers. Use $7.0 / 3$ to get 2.333...

⁵The modulus operator % works only on integers.

Operator Precedence (Order of Operations)

- C follows maths-like precedence:
 - $\ast$ / $\%$ **before** $+$ $-$
 - Same level $\rightarrow$ left to right.
- Use **parentheses** to be explicit and clear.

Example

```
2 + 3 * 4  $\rightarrow$  2 + 12  $\rightarrow$  14  
(2 + 3) * 4  $\rightarrow$  20
```

Assignment & shortcuts

- $x = 5$; stores 5 in x .
- $x += 2$; means $x = x + 2$;
- $x++$; increases x by 1 ($x = x + 2$)
- $x--$; decreases x by 1 ($x = x - 1$)

Relational and Logical Operators

Relational — compare two values

Result is **true (1)** or **false (0)**.

Op	Meaning	Example
==	equal to	5 == 5 → 1
!=	not equal	5 != 3 → 1
>	greater than	5 > 3 → 1
<	less than	5 < 3 → 0
>=	greater/equal	5 >= 5 → 1
<=	less/equal	4 <= 3 → 0

Logical — combine conditions

Used to join or invert true/false tests.

Op	Meaning	True when
&&	AND	both are true ^a
	OR	at least one is true ^b
!	NOT	flips true/false

^ae.g. (age >= 18 && age < 60) is true only for ages 18 to 59

^be.g. (age < 18 || age >= 60) is true for ages below 18 or 60 and above

Assignment and Increment Operators

Operator	Meaning
<code>x = 5</code>	assign 5 to x
<code>x += 2</code>	<code>x = x + 2</code>
<code>x -= 3</code>	<code>x = x - 3</code>
<code>x *= 4</code>	<code>x = x * 4</code>
<code>x /= 5</code>	<code>x = x / 5</code>

```
int x = 10;  
x += 5;    // 15  
x -= 3;    // 12  
x *= 2;    // 24  
x /= 4;    // 6
```

Final value of x is 6

A Peek at Bitwise Operators

Working at the level of bits

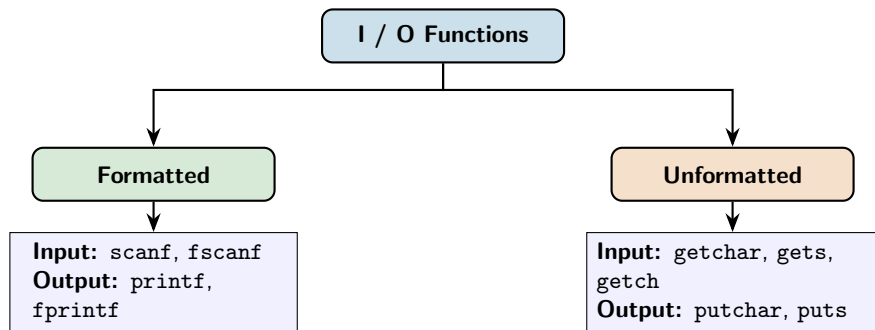
Bitwise operators act on the individual **0/1 bits** of an integer. They are common in *embedded systems* and *hardware control* — handy to recognise even as a beginner.

```
int a = 5;    // 0101
int b = 3;    // 0011

a & b;        // 0001 = 1  (AND)
a | b;        // 0111 = 7  (OR)
a ^ b;        // 0110 = 6  (XOR)
~a;           // flips all bits
a << 1;       // 1010 = 10 (x2)
a >> 1;       // 0010 = 2  (/2)
```

- `&` AND — 1 only if *both* bits are 1.
- `|` OR — 1 if *any* bit is 1.
- `^` XOR — 1 if the bits *differ*.
- `~` NOT — flips every bit.
- `<<` left shift — multiplies by 2.
- `>>` right shift — divides by 2.

Classification of I/O Functions



- **Formatted** functions use *format specifiers* (`%d`, `%f`, ...) to control layout — our focus.
- **Unformatted** functions read/write raw characters or strings without formatting.

Output with printf — Format Specifiers

Specifier	Used for	Example
%d	integer	<code>printf("%d", 42);</code> → 42
%f	float / double	<code>printf("%f", 3.14);</code> → 3.140000
%c	single character	<code>printf("%c", 'A');</code> → A
%s	string (text)	<code>printf("%s", "Hi");</code> → Hi

Width & precision

`%5d` — at least 5 columns wide.

`%.2f` — 2 digits after the point.

`printf("%.2f", 3.14159);` → 3.14

Escape sequences

`\n` new line `\t` tab

`\\` backslash `\"` quote

Input with scanf

```
int age;  
printf("Enter your age: ");  
scanf("%d", &age);           /* note the & (address of age) */  
printf("Next year you will be %d\n", age + 1);
```

- scanf reads typed input and stores it in a variable.
- **Crucial:** put an & (“address of”) before the variable — &age.
- The specifier must match the type: %d int, %f float, %c char, %s string.

Reading several values

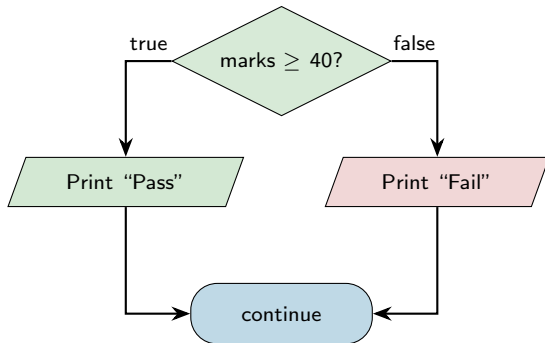
`scanf("%d %f", &n, &x);` reads an integer then a float.

Sample run: →

Making Decisions: if / if-else

```
if (marks >= 40) {  
    printf("Pass\n");  
} else {  
    printf("Fail\n");  
}
```

- The condition in () is either **true** or **false**.
- Comparisons: == != < > <= >=
- **Trap:** == tests equality; = *assigns*!



Choosing Among Many: switch

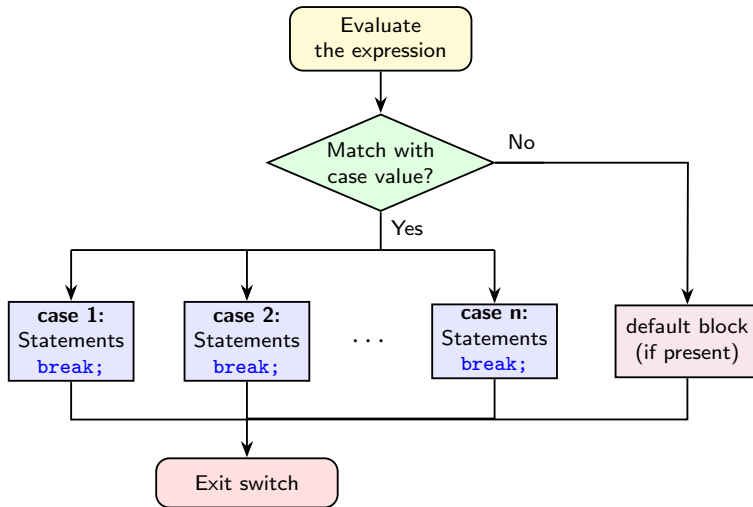
```
switch (choice) {  
    case 1:  
        printf("Add\n");  
        break;  
    case 2:  
        printf("Subtract\n");  
        break;  
    default:  
        printf("Invalid\n");  
}
```

- Compares one variable against several case values.
- `break;` stops “falling through” to the next case — **don't forget it.**
- `default:` runs if nothing else matches.
- Cleaner than a long `if--else if` chain.

Note

case labels must be constant integers or characters (e.g. 1, 'A').

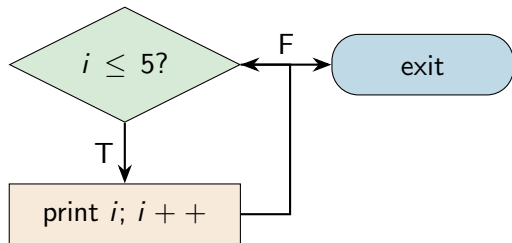
Flow of Control in switch-case



Loops: while and do--while

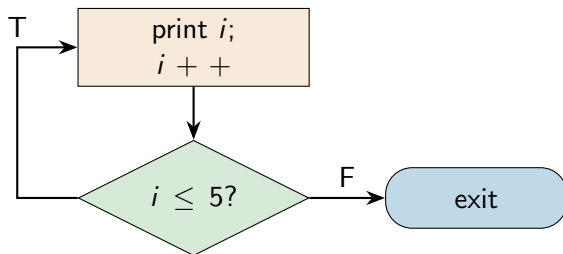
while — test *first*, may run 0 times:

```
int i = 1;
while (i <= 5) {
    printf("%d ", i);
    i++;
}
```



do--while — test *after*, runs ≥ 1 time:

```
int i = 1;
do {
    printf("%d ", i);
    i++;
} while (i <= 5);
```



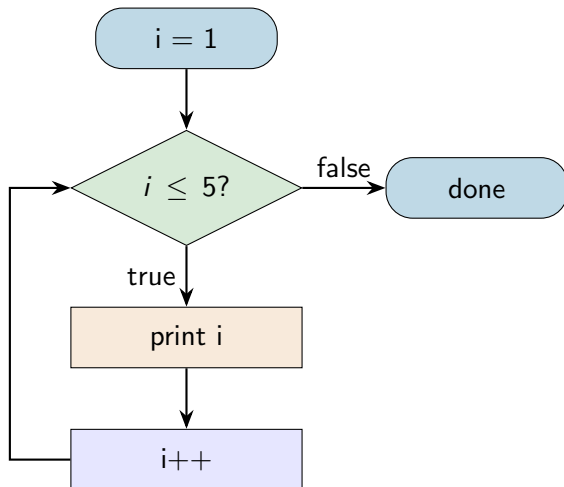
Both print `1 2 3 4 5`. Use do--while when the body must run at least once.

Loops: the for Loop

```
int i;  
for (i = 1; i <= 5; i++) {  
    printf("%d ", i);  
}
```

The three parts of a for loop:

- 1 **Initialization:** $i = 1$ — runs once at the start.
- 2 **Condition:** $i \leq 5$ — checked before each pass.
- 3 **Update:** $i++$ — runs after each pass.



A for loop is a compact while loop — suitable when the iteration count is known in advance.

break and continue

break — exit the loop immediately.

```
for (int i = 1; i <= 10; i++) {  
    if (i == 7)  
        break;  
    printf("%d ", i);  
}  
// Output: 1 2 3 4 5 6
```

continue — skip to the next iteration.

```
for (i = 1; i <= 10; i++) {  
    if (i == 3)  
        continue;  
    printf("%d ", i);  
}  
// Output: 1 2 4 5 6 7 8 9 10
```

Statement	Effect
break	Terminates the loop completely
continue	Skips the current iteration and proceeds to the next one

Remember

break **leaves** the loop; **continue** **jumps to the next round**. Both also appear inside while/do--while; break additionally ends a switch case.

First C Program: “Hello, World!”

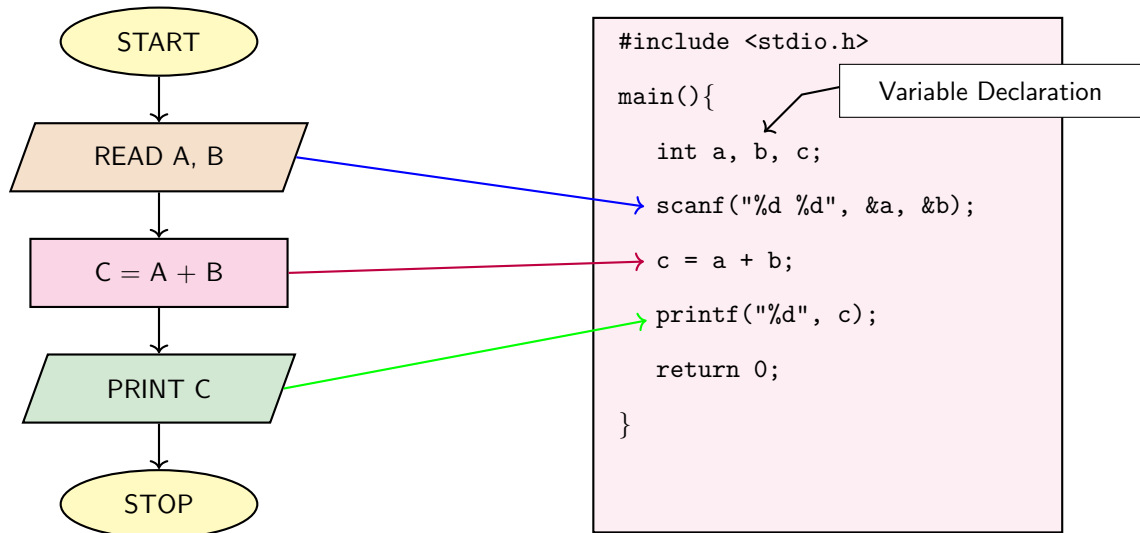
```
#include <stdio.h>           /* bring in input/output library */

int main(void)               /* execution starts here */
{
    printf("Hello, World!\n"); /* print a message */
    return 0;                 /* 0 = success */
}
```

- We now know the skeleton, keywords, data types and I/O — so we can write real programs.
- `printf` prints text;
- `'\n'` starts a new line.
- Every statement ends with a semicolon `‘;’`
- `return 0;` reports success to the OS.

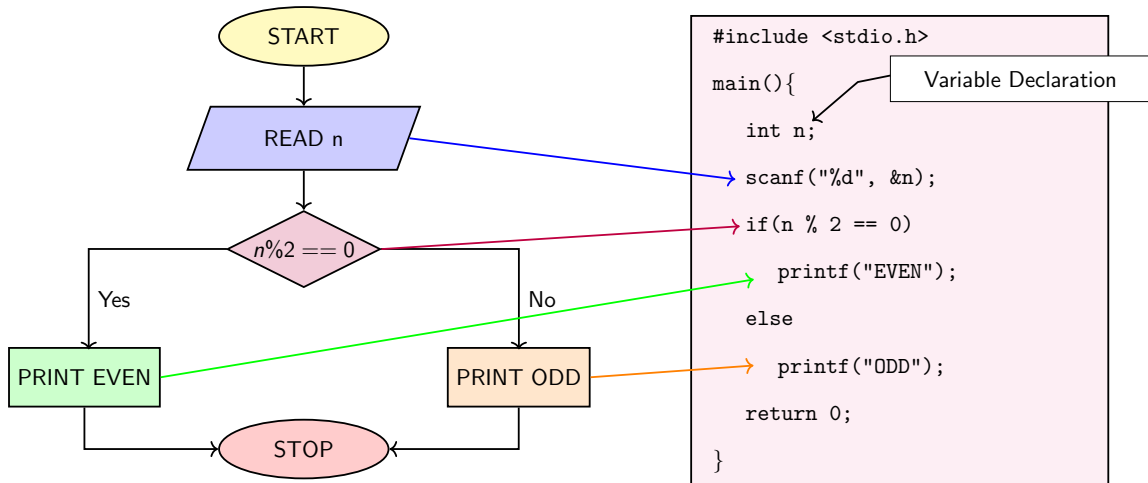
Output: Hello, World!

Worked Example 1: Adding two numbers



Each flowchart step on the left maps to a coloured line of C code on the right.

Worked Example 2: Even or Odd (if--else)



The green and red branches match the two printf lines. A number is even when $n \% 2$ is 0.

Worked Example 3 — Sum of 1 to N (a for loop)

```
#include <stdio.h>

int main(void)
{
    int n, i, sum = 0;

    printf("Enter N: ");
    scanf("%d", &n);

    for (i = 1; i <= n; i++){
        sum += i;    /* sum = sum + i */
    }

    printf("Sum of first %d natural number = %d\n", n, sum);
    return 0;
}
```

Program Output

Enter N: 5

Sum of first 5 natural number = 15

Trace for N = 5

i	sum
1	1
2	3
3	6
4	10
5	15

Worked Example 4 — Simple Calculator (switch)

```
#include <stdio.h>
int main(void) {
    float a, b;  char op;
    printf("Enter: a op b (e.g. 6 * 7): ");
    scanf("%f %c %f", &a, &op, &b);

    switch (op) {
        case '+': printf("= %.2f\n", a + b); break;
        case '-': printf("= %.2f\n", a - b); break;
        case '*': printf("= %.2f\n", a * b); break;
        case '/':
            if (b != 0) printf("= %.2f\n", a / b);
            else        printf("Cannot divide by zero!\n");
            break;
        default:  printf("Unknown operator\n");
    }
    return 0;
}
```

Pseudocode

- 1 START
- 2 READ N
- 3 Set M = 1
- 4 Set F = 1
- 5 REPEAT
 - $F = F * M$
 - If $M = N$, go to Step 6
 - Otherwise, set $M = M + 1$
- 6 PRINT F
- 7 STOP

Program Output

Enter N: 5

Factorial = 120

C Program

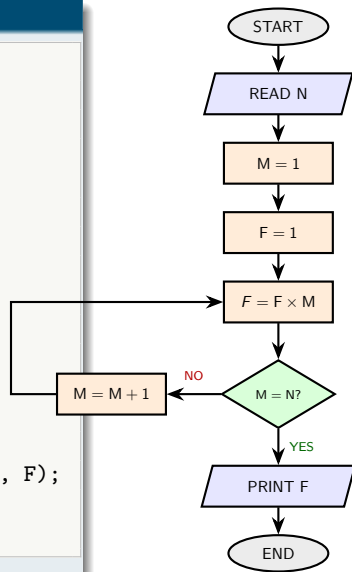
```
#include <stdio.h>

int main(){
    int N, M = 1;
    unsigned long long F = 1;

    printf("Enter N: ");
    scanf("%d", &N);

    while (M <= N) {
        F = F * M;
        M = M + 1;    // M++
    }

    printf("Factorial = %llu\n", F);
    return 0;
}
```



Pseudocode

- 1 START
- 2 READ two numbers num_1 and num_2
- 3 Compare num_1 and num_2
- 4 If num_1 > num_2
 DISPLAY num_1
- 5 Otherwise
 DISPLAY num_2
- 6 STOP

Program Output

Enter two numbers: 17 9
Largest number = 17

C Program

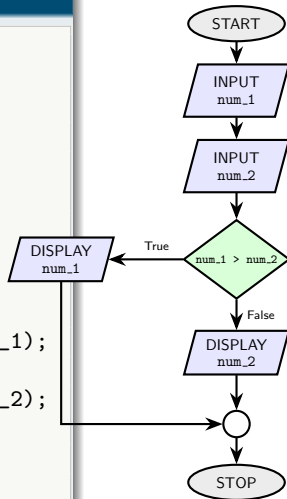
```
#include <stdio.h>

int main(void)
{
    int num_1, num_2;

    printf("Enter two numbers: ");
    scanf("%d %d", &num_1, &num_2);

    if (num_1 > num_2)
        printf("Larger number = %d\n", num_1);
    else
        printf("Larger number = %d\n", num_2);

    return 0;
}
```



Summary & What Comes Next

Concept

- How a computer is organized and what an OS does.
- Machine / assembly / high-level languages.
- How a C program is written, compiled, and run.
- Data types, operators, and control structures.
- Formatted input/output with `printf/scanf`.

Practice makes perfect

- Type and run every example yourself.
- Deliberately make errors — read the messages.
- Modify examples: change values, add features.

Coming up

Functions, arrays, strings, and pointers.

Thank You

Questions?